Event check-in system: summary for the director

To: Office director

From: Saathvik Maheshuni

Data: One fall term of synthetic data (40 events, 1,800 students). The numbers show what the new reports can find. They do not come from a real office.

My recommendation: replace the three spreadsheets (registrations, sign-in sheets and the follow-up tracker) with one system for registration and check-in. Try it first on information sessions before using it at the career fair.

What one term of records shows

Attendance records are incomplete and late. When I loaded the term's spreadsheets into a database, 15.6% of rows needed a fix or a manual check. 127 registration rows and 19 sign-in rows could not be matched to a student, so those students are missing from the attendance counts. 41 of the walk-ins may be registered students whose sign-up was never matched. 89 registrations were duplicates, and 50 more look like second sign-ups.

43.9% of active registrations did not show up, and the no-shows follow a pattern. Students who registered 15 or more days early missed 59.6% of the time. Those who registered 1 to 3 days before missed 38.9%. This suggests sending a reminder close to the event, and the pilot should test that with real check-ins.

Only 49 of 71 attendee lists went out to employers within 3 business days (69.0%). 9 were late and 13 were never sent.

What changes

Students register with a student ID that is checked against the roster, so duplicates are blocked and full events put students on a waitlist automatically. Staff scan a QR code or ID card at the door and look up walk-ins on the roster. That way attendance is ready as soon as the event ends. Each employer gets a follow-up task due 3 business days after the event, and overdue tasks show up on the coordinator's list. Four reports replace the matching by hand: attendance, no-shows, follow-up status and data quality.

I built a working prototype (database schema, migration of the old spreadsheets and six reports), and it passes all 18 acceptance tests. Door staffing can follow the arrival pattern: 39.6% of check-ins came in the first 10 minutes after the start, and 74.4% of students had arrived by then.

Decisions needed

1. Approve a one-term pilot on information sessions.
2. Name an owner for the employer list and for the daily roster file.
3. Choose when reminders go out: one day or two days before the event.
4. Confirm the on-time follow-up target proposed in the requirements document.

Limitations: the data is synthetic, so the size of each problem is only an example. Some patterns come from how I made the data, and I built the no-show pattern above into it on purpose. The prototype covers the data rules and reports. It has no screens for students, email reminders or offline check-in, since a vendor or campus system would provide those. I did not look at costs or vendor options.